

Make your website accessible to all

Your website needs to be accessible to all regardless of disabilities, infrastructure, and mode of access. Here is a primer on how you can get that done.

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here is a clear distinction between websites that are made for all platforms versus those

made just for a single medium of access. And if you have run a website of your own then you might be familiar with Google's webmaster tools and all the different reports that it can generate. There is a particularly good chance that you might have received an alert for ensuring good mobile accessibility. Perhaps, some of the elements were too close to each other or a few elements might have rendered outside the viewport. There are numerous factors which we might not consider while designing the front-end of a website and you had to rely on experienced designers and developers to ensure such oversights did not happen. Not anymore, there are now numerous tools available which can analyse your website, identify issues and give you pointers on how you can fix the same. Let us look at some of the key accessibility factors that affect your website.

MOBILE SCREENS

The number one accessibility factor for websites is its ability to render and function properly on small

screens. Responsive design meant that you could build a single website and then have it function the same no matter what device a user was on while coming to your website. However, with smartphones having become ubiquitous, it is imperative that you design your websites 'mobile first'. Google, the almighty web company, has switched its search

keeping it simple to navigate because you no longer rely on a precise mouse, rather you have to ensure that stubby human fingers can easily navigate a website and accurately interact with the elements that the user has to. For this to happen, interactive elements must be larger than usual, and there should be plenty of space between two interactive elements. The last thing you want is to place your CTA (Call to Action) button right next to an exit button and lose out on half your reader-base purely because they couldn't click the right button and weren't bothered to go back to the page for a retry.



Responsive design – One site for all screens

engine to crawl the World Wide Web using a mobile user-agent rather than a desktop user-agent. Which means your website is now judged based on how well it works on small screens.

This meant that you had to squeeze an immense number of elements into a small real estate while

Responsive design is overly complex to implement so a lot of publishers will make two websites, one that is mobile and the other for desktop users. You can have a single responsive website, but you better have a great IT team that can handle the complexity and run proper QA